

Position Paper

A position paper, in a Model United Nations, is a formal document that outlines your allocated nation's stance on the topics being discussed within your assigned committee. It serves as a basis for your participation, demonstrating your research and understanding of your nation's foreign policy in regard to the agenda matter at hand.

Each position paper must clearly and concisely state your nation's position on the agenda. Support this stance with thorough research, including relevant historical context, relevant statistical data, and a summary of your nation's actions in regard to the agenda and its sub-agendas. Develop specific, actionable proposed solutions, referencing relevant international treaties and UN resolutions to strengthen your arguments. Ensure all claims are backed with verifiable evidence and credible sources.

We, the executive board, expect well-organized, thoroughly researched position papers that reflect a clear grasp of the issues and your allocated nation's perspective. Adherence to formats and guidelines is a must. Evaluation will focus on research quality, adherence to the format, and the practicality of proposed policies.

I) Format

1. Flag and Coat of Arms

- Include the Country's Flag and Coat of Arms in the position paper according to the format in the sample.

2. Introduction

- Begin your position paper with a concise introduction that introduces the topic and highlights its global significance.
- Provide essential background information about the topic, including its historical context, current status, and key developments.

3. Your Country's Stance including Past and Ongoing Efforts

- Clearly state your country's position and stance on the topic. This should reflect your country's interests, policies, and priorities.
- Discuss any past or ongoing efforts by your country or the international community related to the topic. Highlight your country's contributions, initiatives, or collaborations.

4 . Proposed Solutions and Recommendations

- Present a set of proposed solutions or recommendations that align with your country's stance and address the topic's challenges. These should be practical, actionable, and relevant to the issue.

6. References

- Include a list of all the references and sources you used in your position paper. This shows the credibility of your research.

Note:

- Keep your position papers limited to a maximum of 1 – 1.5 pages without references, and paragraphs without titles, as shown in the sample.
- Write your position paper in clear, concise, and diplomatic language. Avoid jargon and technical terms that may not be widely understood.

- Font Style: Times New Roman, Font Size: 12px
- Margin: 1 inch on all sides
- Line spacing: 1.5

II) Research Guidelines

1. All UN Websites:

- The United Nations (UN) network of official websites, including those of its specialized agencies, committees, and programs, serves as a primary research hub. These sites provide critical data, official resolutions, comprehensive reports, and authoritative documents directly relevant to UN agendas. Delegates can leverage this information to build a strong foundation for their position papers, ensuring accuracy and alignment with official UN discourse. Access to these resources allows for in-depth research on specific topics, enabling delegates to craft well-informed arguments and propose effective solutions.

2. Countries' Official Websites:

- An official government website is crucial for understanding a nation's foreign policy, official stances on international issues, and past diplomatic actions. For position paper writing, these websites offer direct insights into a country's priorities and perspectives. Delegates can extract key policy statements, official declarations, and historical context to accurately represent their assigned country's viewpoint. This ensures that position papers reflect authentic national positions and contribute to informed debate.

3. Official Documents:

- Official UN and international organization documents, such as resolutions, treaty texts, and in-depth reports, are the bedrock of authoritative research. Delegates must consult these primary sources to substantiate their arguments and ensure their position papers are grounded in official records. These documents provide the factual basis for claims, allow for precise citations, and demonstrate a thorough understanding of the subject matter. Utilizing official documents enhances the credibility and persuasiveness of any position paper.

4. Press Releases by the Government:

- Government press releases contain official statements and announcements made by a country's government. These releases often convey a country's position on specific issues, policies, and diplomatic initiatives. Delegates can cite government press releases to provide evidence of a country's stance.

III) Sample Position Paper



Country: The United States of America

Committee: United Nations Children's Fund

Agenda: *Supporting and Safeguarding Children
from Households Impacted by Domestic Violence
or Substance Abuse*



The United States of America is honored to address the United Nations Children's Fund regarding the critical challenges faced by young children in families affected by domestic violence or substance abuse. We strongly support the development of systems to protect these vulnerable children, ensuring they do not witness such atrocities in their own homes. Our goal is to provide every child with a loving and supportive environment, promoting opportunities for them to achieve the American Dream.

Domestic violence and substance abuse have serious effects on children. The World Health Organization estimates that 1 billion children aged 2-17 experience violence or neglect each year. Witnessing domestic violence can result in long-term psychological trauma, behavioral issues, and developmental delays, including learning difficulties and lower IQ scores. It can alter children's DNA, aging them 7-10 years and increasing their risk of suicide by six times and violent crime by 74%. Moreover, substance abuse in the household worsens these problems, with children of parents with substance use disorders being three times more likely to be abused. This environment leads to a cycle of violence and substance dependency, with affected children being 50% more likely to abuse drugs and alcohol as adults. Globally, 17.3% of people have experienced physical violence from a family member, while 16.5% have witnessed it.

The United Nations has made significant efforts to address children's rights through various declarations and conventions, notably the Convention on the Rights of the Child (CRC) of 1989, which builds on earlier documents like the Declaration of the Rights of the Child (1959) and the Geneva Declaration (1924). The core principles emphasize child protection, but challenges in implementation persist due to inadequate funding, lack of enforcement, and cultural barriers. Although the CRC has been ratified by 196 countries, compliance varies greatly, leading to gaps

in support for children. The United States is one of only two countries that have not ratified the CRC, citing concerns about potential negative impacts on children's autonomy and congressional limitations.

The United States has implemented numerous programs and initiatives to combat domestic violence and substance abuse, focusing on both prevention and support for affected children. Organizations such as the National Child Traumatic Stress Network (NCTSN) and the National Court Appointed Special Advocate Association (CASA) work tirelessly to provide resources, advocacy, and support for children in distress. Additionally, legislative measures and community-based programs aim to create safer environments and offer rehabilitation for families. The U.S. government remains committed to refining these efforts and ensuring that every child has the opportunity to thrive in a safe and nurturing environment, as The United States believes “All persons influence their social environment and in turn are influenced by it”.

To tackle domestic violence and substance abuse affecting children, the United States suggests a collaborative approach:

- Establish stronger international standards for child protection.
- Enhance international cooperation and information sharing.
- Increase funding for global initiatives and local child protection programs.
- Invest in education and awareness campaigns to prevent abuse.
- Implement monitoring systems to ensure adherence to standards and track progress.

References:

<https://cpd.org.rs/wp-content/uploads/2017/11/01 - Declaration of Geneva 1924.pdf>

<https://digitallibrary.un.org/record/195831?ln=en&v=pdf>

<https://www.unicef.org/child-rights-convention/convention-text>

<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC10913340>

<https://www.dvs-or.org/children-domestic-violence-statistics/e>

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/violence-against-children>

<https://www.nctsn.org/>

<https://nationalcasagal.org/>

https://legal.un.org/ilc/texts/instruments/english/conventions/1_1_1969.pdf